



Louise Brown, the first baby conceived through IVF, holds her father's hand shortly after her birth at Oldham General Hospital, UK.

Newspaper reports of the birth of the first "test tube baby" caused a flurry of both praise for the achievement and condemnation for "meddling with nature."

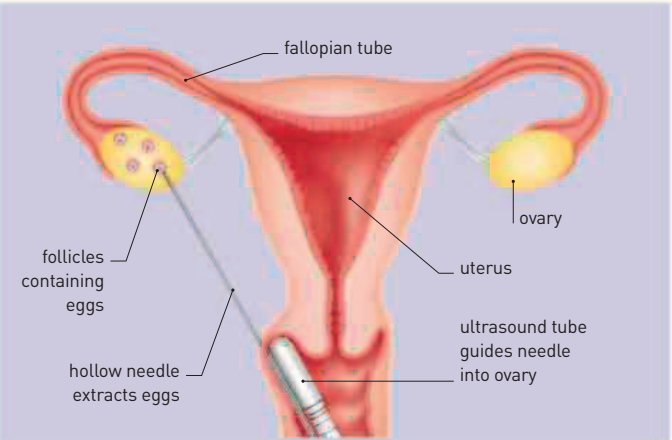
Since the birth of Louise Brown, several million babies have been conceived through IVF.

In another technological substitute for a natural process, US company Genetech announced that it had managed to **genetically engineer** *E.coli* bacteria to produce the hormone **insulin**. People suffering from diabetes

Ancient footprints

The footprints at Laetoli, preserved in hardened volcanic ash, were made by three individuals apparently on their way to a watering hole.

(Type I) cannot produce enough of this hormone, and at the time, their only source of life-saving supplementary insulin was from pigs and cattle. The US Food and Drug Administration (FDA) approved Genetech's product in 1982, making it the first genetically engineered product to gain approval.



IN VITRO FERTILIZATION

In this assisted fertilization technique, a woman's ovaries are stimulated (using drugs) to produce several eggs. The eggs are extracted, and combined with sperm in the laboratory. One or two of the embryos produced are then implanted into the woman's womb to develop into fetuses. Since first introduced, IVF has become more sophisticated and there are many ways to achieve egg fertilization.



June 19 A team led by US physicist David Wineland announces that they have **trapped** a cloud of **magnesium atoms** using a laser—it would prove significant in the development of quantum computing

July 25 Birth of Louise Brown, the first baby conceived through IVF

September 6 US company Genetech announces that it has **genetically engineered** bacteria to produce **insulin**

November 13 NASA launches the **Einstein Observatory**—the first dedicated X-ray telescope